Gretchen Daily



Born in 1964 in Washington, D.C., Gretchen Daily developed a passion for ecology at a young age. After her family moved to West Germany in 1977, she witnessed a national crisis over acid rain, and saw people protesting in the streets over environmental degradation. Daily earned two degrees and then her Ph.D. in biology at Stanford University, where she is now the Bing Professor of Environmental Science.

Daily studies biodiversity within the framework of "countryside biogeography," or the portions of nature that have not been used for human development, but whose ecosystems are still impacted by human activity. She is a cofounder of the Natural Capital Project, which aims to incorporate environmentalism into business practices and public policy.

Key works

1997 *Nature's Services: Societal Dependence on Natural Ecosystems*

2002 *The New Economy of Nature: The Quest to Make Conservation Profitable*

See also: Human activity and biodiversity • Ecological resilience • The Gaia hypothesis • Human devastation of Earth